# Praise of the Five Tathāgatas

Pañcatathāgatastava · Toh 1164 · Derge Tengyur
དཔེ་ཅེན་གཤེགས་པ་ལྔ་ཡང་བསྟོད་པ

Praise of the Five Tathāgatas, known in Sanskrit as Pañca Tathāgata Stava and in Tibetan as Dezhin Shekpa Nga la Töpa, is a short hymn in verse addressed to the five buddhas of tantric Buddhism. After an opening homage to the Lord of Speech, it devotes a stanza to each buddha in turn, Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha and Amoghasiddhi, describing the color of his body, his radiance, and the throne on which he sits, borne by lions, elephants, horses, peacocks and garuḍas. A closing stanza gathers the five together with their colors, their hand gestures and their jeweled crowns, praising them as the embodiment of the five wisdoms. It is Toh 1164 in the Tengyur, where it is placed among the hymns of praise (stotra) that make up the Praises section.

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In Sanskrit: pañca tathāgata stavaḥ
In Tibetan: Praise of the Five Tathāgatas.

Homage to the Lord of Speech.

Protector of the three worlds, gone to the far shore of boundless qualities,
Possessed of a lovely body, white and vast as an ocean of milk,
Unequalled, suchness itself, seated upon a lion throne:
To that supreme sage Vairocana I pay homage.

Whose light, streaming forth like a great and lustrous sapphire,
Illuminates every direction without exception,
A marvel in the three worlds, seated upon an elephant throne:
To that fearless Buddha Akṣobhya I always pay homage.

Skilled in working for the benefit of beings through the riches of the jewel empowerment,
Possessing the accumulation of merit, like the king of mountains (Mount Meru) moving in visible form,
Like an ocean of gold, seated upon a horse throne:
To that sage Ratnasambhava I always pay homage.

With the light of a radiance graced by a hundred brilliant peacocks
Covering every direction, delightful is the Lotus One,
Lovely as a mountain of ruby, seated upon a peacock throne:
To that sage Amitābha I pay homage.

Who dispels the darkness with masses of light rays of the sublime Dharma,
Whose radiant light completely fills every quarter of the sky,
Like an ocean of beryl, seated upon a garuḍa throne:
To that Buddha Amoghasiddhi I pay homage.

Seated in vajra posture upon lion, elephant, horse, peacock and garuḍa thrones,
Their bodies in turn white, blue, yellow, stainless red and green,
Marked by the gestures (mudrās) of supreme awakening, touching the earth, supreme giving, meditative absorption and granting fearlessness,
Wearing jeweled crowns of their own families: to that embodiment of the five wisdoms I bow.

This concludes the Praise of the Five Tathāgatas.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Padmākaravarman and the chief editor-translator, the monk Rinchen Zangpo.

## Translator's Notes

• The Lord of Speech in the opening homage is most likely Mañjuśrī in his form as Vāgīśvara. In the third verse, the phrase rendered "like the king of mountains moving in visible form" is compressed and the reading is tentative. In the fourth verse, "the Lotus One" is taken as Amitābha, lord of the lotus family; the words for "lotus" and "ruby" could alternatively be read together as padmarāga, "lotus-hued ruby."

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.